

Atomic Habits — Mastery Quiz

Author: James Clear • 12 multiple-choice questions • Answer + explanation

Instructions: Choose the best answer before checking the answer and explanation.

1. What is the central idea behind the 1% improvement concept?

- A. Make dramatic changes once a year
- B. Small improvements compound over time
- C. Focus only on motivation
- D. Avoid routines

Correct answer: B

Why: Repeated small improvements can accumulate into major results.

2. Which sequence represents the habit loop?

- A. Goal → Plan → Result → Reward
- B. Cue → Craving → Response → Reward
- C. Cue → Action → Goal → Identity
- D. Reward → Cue → Plan → Result

Correct answer: B

Why: The four stages explain how habits are triggered, performed and reinforced.

3. Which layer is deepest in behavior change?

- A. Outcomes
- B. Processes
- C. Identity
- D. Rewards

Correct answer: C

Why: Identity focuses on becoming the type of person who naturally performs the behavior.

4. What does 'make it obvious' mean?

- A. Hide the cue
- B. Make the desired habit visible and clear
- C. Make the habit harder
- D. Wait for motivation

Correct answer: B

Why: Visible cues increase the chance that the behavior will be remembered and started.

5. What is the Two-Minute Rule designed to do?

- A. Limit all work to two minutes
- B. Make the first step of a habit very easy
- C. Replace sleep
- D. Track two habits

Correct answer: B

Why: The rule shrinks a habit to an easy starting action so repetition becomes easier.

6. How can you make a bad habit less attractive?

- A. Increase its reward
- B. Pair it with something enjoyable
- C. Reframe its consequences negatively
- D. Put its cue in front of you

Correct answer: C

Why: Making a bad habit unattractive reduces its craving.

7. Why is environment important?

- A. It eliminates all effort
- B. It changes the cues and friction surrounding behavior
- C. It guarantees success
- D. It replaces identity

Correct answer: B

Why: Environment strongly influences which cues are noticed and how easy actions are.

8. What is the lesson of 'never miss twice'?

- A. Never make mistakes
- B. Recover quickly after a missed habit
- C. Double the habit next time
- D. Stop tracking

Correct answer: B

Why: A single miss is less important than preventing it from becoming a repeated pattern.

9. What should you optimize first when starting a habit?

- A. Maximum intensity
- B. Complexity
- C. Repetition and consistency
- D. Perfect measurement

Correct answer: C

Why: Repeated execution builds the habit before optimization of performance.

10. What is habit tracking mainly useful for?

- A. Making progress visible
- B. Replacing the habit
- C. Increasing difficulty
- D. Eliminating rewards

Correct answer: A

Why: Tracking provides visible feedback and can reinforce consistency.

11. Which is *NOT* one of the four laws for building habits?

- A. Make it obvious
- B. Make it attractive
- C. Make it difficult
- D. Make it satisfying

Correct answer: C

Why: The third law is to make it easy, not difficult.

12. What ultimately makes habits powerful?

- A. One exceptional day
- B. Repeated actions over time
- C. Willpower alone
- D. Constant novelty

Correct answer: B

Why: Habits compound because repeated behavior accumulates.

Scoring guide: 10–12 = strong mastery • 7–9 = good understanding • 4–6 = review the summary • 0–3
= reread the core concepts.